attempting to supplant the mainstream parties (the conservative UMP, the socialist PS, and the centrist UDI). Even they have been accompanied and outdone by grassroots movements of all sorts, from La Manif pour Tous—a family values-oriented movement, to Bonnets Rouges (Red bonnets)—a large-scale civil rebellion in Britanny, to the aforementioned Jour de Colère.

But again, why the Jews? Why should the Jews, of all people, be turned again into scapegoats by such diverse constituencies, when things deteriorate? Why should antisemitism work so well *now* in France and in many other European countries, in spite of so many educational programs about the Holocaust and as society is turning increasingly multiracial, multicultural, and multireligious?

A second, deeper, answer is thus needed. My personal assessment is that antisemitism endures, and explodes when suitable circumstances are present, because it is embedded in world culture, human fantasies, and universal nighmares. The real problem with Jews is that they produced the Bible, the all-time bestseller; and, that the Bible deals chiefly with the Jews. Something that non-Jews, overwhelmingly the largest group of Bible readers in the world, tend to resent.

In Western countries, including France, antisemitism ultimately can be boiled down to the Marcionite tradition. Marcion, a 2nd-century bishop in Sinope (in present-day Turkey), attempted to resolve a basic Christian dilemma: if Jesus was the culmination of the Jewish faith, why did Jews reject him; or, alternatively, why did Christians not become Jews? Marcion took a dualistic approach. The Gospel, he contended, was not the culmination of the Hebrew Bible but rather its antidote. God of the Old Testament he perceived as the Demiurge who created the material world—who was, in fact, the Devil. Jesus, then, was the spiritual God of the Gospel, whose task was to rescue humanity from this Old Testament God. Jews, accordingly, were the Devil's people, an intrinsically perverse and evil nation, whose purpose was to *kill Jesus* again and again, in order to delay, obfuscate, or actually prevent salvation.[5]

All the major churches—Orthodox, Catholic, and later on, Protestant as well—forcefully rejected Marcionism as a heresy. Their theologians resolved the Jewish-Christian dilemma by looking to St. Paul's paradox in the Epistle to the Romans: Jews were not rejected by God, even if they failed to acknowledge Jesus as the Messiah (Rom. 11:1); their effacement was only temporary, as a ploy to help "jealous" Gentiles to take part in the grand work of faith and salvation (Rom. 11:11); at the end of time, when Jews would "return to God," they would recover their supremely exalted position (Rom.

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